Activity:

Complete the given table with the help of an atlas. Follow the example.

S. No.	Mountain Ranges	Peaks	Continents	Elevation (m)
1.	The Himalayas	Everest	Asia	8,848
2.	The Rockies			
3.	The Andes			
4.	The Alps			
5.	The Eastern Ghats			

the **Andes** of South America are such examples. The Andes mountain in South America is the longest mountain range (7,000 km) in the world. The highest point of a mountain is known as its **peak**. Mt. Everest is the highest peak (8,848 m) in the world. Which country is Mt. Everest located in?

HOTS: You know the importance of conservation of forests. Do you think conservation of mountains is also equally important?

Mountains are the sources of rivers. They provide shelter to flora and fauna. Here, tourism is an important activity. During summer, people go to mountain regions to enjoy the pleasing cool weather. Udhagamandalam, Kodaikanal, Kolli hills, Yercaud and Yelagiri are some of the hill stations found in Tamil Nadu.

2.2 Plateaus

Plateaus are the elevated portions of the Earth that have flat surfaces bounded by steep slopes. The elevation of plateaus may be a few hundred or several thousand metres. **Tibetan Plateau** is the highest plateau in the world. So, it is called as the '**Roof of the world'.** The flat topped part of the plateau is called **Tableland**. The plateaus are generally rich in minerals. The **Chotanagpur Plateau** is one of the mineral rich plateaus in India. Therefore, mining is one of the major activities of the people living here. The **Deccan Plateau** in peninsular India is of volcanic origin.



Dharmapuri Plateau, Coimbatore Plateau and Madurai Plateau are found in Tamil Nadu.

2.3 Plains

Plains are flat and relatively low-lying lands. Plains are usually less than 200 metre above sea level. Sometimes they may be rolling or undulating. Most plains are formed by rivers and their tributaries and distributaries. These plains are used extensively for agriculture due to the availability of water and fertile soil.



The plains have been the cradle of civilisations from the earliest times. For example: the Indus in India, the Nile valley in Egypt are some of the early civilisations which developed and flourished.